

A KRINGSTAR AI PROPERTY GUIDE

2026 Lagos Security Report & Scam-Proof Checklist

How to verify a title, spot a fake agent, and protect your money before you pay a single naira.

Prepared for verified buyers in the Ajah & Sangotedo corridor

Why This Report Exists

Property fraud is one of the most common ways buyers lose money in Lagos real estate. Fake titles, impersonated agents, and pressure to pay before documents are seen have cost buyers millions of naira. This report gives you a practical, no-jargon checklist to protect yourself — whether you're working with us or anyone else.

This is educational information for any Lagos property buyer. It is not legal advice. Always confirm details directly with LASRERA and a licensed legal practitioner before completing a purchase.

Section 1: Red Flags That Signal a Scam

If you notice any of the following during a property search, slow down and verify independently before proceeding.

- ✗ The agent pressures you to pay quickly, citing “other buyers waiting” or a limited-time discount.
- ✗ You're asked to pay before seeing the original title documents, not just photocopies.
- ✗ The price is significantly below similar properties in the same area with no clear explanation.
- ✗ The agent avoids meeting in person or refuses a physical site visit.
- ✗ Payment is requested to a personal account rather than a registered company or escrow account.
- ✗ The agent cannot produce a valid LASRERA registration number when asked.
- ✗ The property has multiple different “owners” claiming rights, or the boundaries are disputed by neighbours.
- ✗ You are discouraged from doing your own independent search at the Lagos State Land Registry.

Section 2: How to Verify a Title, Step by Step

- ✓ Request the Certificate of Occupancy (C of O) or Governor's Consent — confirm it is an original, not a photocopy.

- ✓ Conduct an independent search at the Lagos State Land Registry (or instruct a lawyer to do this on your behalf) to confirm the title is genuine and free of encumbrances.
- ✓ Confirm the seller's name on the title matches the name of the person you are transacting with.
- ✓ Check for any existing mortgage, lien, or court dispute registered against the property.
- ✓ Physically visit the property and confirm boundaries match what is described in the documents.
- ✓ Ask neighbours or the local community/Baale about the property's history before purchase.
- ✓ Use a licensed lawyer to review all documents before any payment is made.

Section 3: How to Verify Your Agent

- ✓ Ask for their LASRERA registration number and confirm it directly with LASRERA, not just by trusting what's shown to you.
- ✓ Search their name and any company they represent online for reviews or complaints.
- ✓ Confirm how long they have operated in the specific corridor you're buying in — established local agents are easier to verify than someone new to the area.
- ✓ Insist on meeting in person and visiting their registered office, if one exists.
- ✓ Never make full payment directly to an individual agent's personal account — payments should go through a verifiable, traceable channel.

Section 4: Payment Safety Rules

- ✓ Never pay in full before documents are independently verified.
- ✓ Where possible, use a staged payment structure tied to verification milestones.
- ✓ Get every payment acknowledged in writing, with a receipt referencing the specific property.
- ✓ Avoid cash payments for large sums — use traceable bank transfers.

- ✓ If anything feels rushed or pressured, pause and seek independent legal advice before proceeding.

Quick Reference: Before You Pay, Confirm...

- ✓ Original title document seen and verified (not a photocopy)
- ✓ Independent Land Registry search completed
- ✓ Agent's LASRERA registration confirmed directly with LASRERA
- ✓ Property physically visited and boundaries confirmed
- ✓ No existing disputes, liens, or competing claims found
- ✓ Lawyer has reviewed all documents
- ✓ Payment goes through a traceable, verifiable channel
- ✓ Written receipt/acknowledgment received for every payment made

Working with a LASRERA-registered agent who insists on title verification, documentation, and transparency — rather than urgency — is one of the strongest protections you have as a buyer.

This report is provided for general educational purposes and does not constitute legal advice. Always consult a licensed legal practitioner and verify directly with LASRERA before completing any property transaction.